Gennadii Iakovlev

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Current position

January 2026 - present *Post-Doc*, ERC Project MENA-PERC, PI Prof. Kevin Koehler, Sant'Anna School of Advanced Studies, Pisa, Italy

Areas of specialization

Large Language Models, Natural Language Processing, Affective Polarization, Democratic Backslides, Regime Change, Democratization

Education

2016-2021 PhD in Political Science, European University Institute, Florence
Thesis: With whom should they make the pact? Preconditions for pacted transitions
Panel: Dorothee Bohle, Vladimir Gel'man, Hanspeter Kriesi, Claudius Wagemann
2018-2019 Erasmus Central European University, Budapest
2016-2017 Master of Research, European University Institute, Florence
2014-2016 MA in Political Science, European University at Saint Petersburg
2010–2014 BA in Political Science, Higher School of Economics, Saint Petersburg

Main Publications

Pre-prints

2026 Iakovlev, Gennadii, Levente Littvay *Introducing Inductive Stylometry Techniques in Political Speeches Using Large Language Models* [arXiV preprint]; under review, *Political Analysis*
2026 Chiarvesio, Francesca, Gennadii Iakovlev *Authoritarian Technocratic Legitimation and Civil Society* [preprint]; R&R Perspectives on Politics
2026 Iakovlev, Gennadii , Elite Affective Polarization in European Parliamentary Speeches: a Novel Measurement Approach Using Large Language Models [arXiV preprint]

Journal articles

2023 Iakovlev, Gennadii "Preconditions for Pacted Transitions from Authoritarian Rule" *European Political Science Review* Volume 15, Issue 2 (2023): 254-271. Nominated for the EPSR Early Careers Prize 2025.
2023 Iakovlev, Gennadii "Take Back Control — Over Brexit Narrative" Review Of Democracy *Book Review*
2018 Sokolov, Mikhail, Sofia Lopatina, and Gennadii Iakovlev. *"From Partnerships to Bureaucracies: The*

Constitutional Evolution of Russian Universities" Educational Studies // Voprosy Obrazovaniya (2018): 120–145 (in Russian; English translation available)

2014 Kostenko, Veronica, and Gennadii Iakovlev. *"Sostav avtorov zhurnala SOCIS v 1975–1981" [The authors of the SOCIS journal in 1975–1981], SocIs* 9 (2014): 123–130 (in Russian)

Data repository

2024 Iakovlev, Gennadii. *"The Correlates of Democratic Backslides" Mendeley Data*

2021 Iakovlev, Gennadii. *"Attempts at Pacts data: the opposition actors in the negotiations on democratization" Mendeley Data*

Articles Under Review

xxxx Iakovlev, Gennadii. *"Does the third wave of autocratization have phases or structural correlates?"* (under review, *Swiss Political Science Review*)

xxxx Iakovlev, Gennadii. *"The organizational structure of Ukraine's revolutions in 2004 and 2014: a case study"* (under review, *Europe-Asia Studies*)

Articles in progress

xxxx Iakovlev, Gennadii, Murat Somer *"Pernicious Polarization in Elite Speeches: a Novel Measurement Approach Using Large Language Models"*

Conference presentations

10/2026 MethodsNet Conference: *"Introducing Inductive Stylometry Techniques in Political Speeches Using Large Language Models"* (with Levente Littvay); *"From homo silicus to homo jevicus: System One models in modeling human behavior"* (with Max Boiten and Levente Littvay)

Teaching experience

Undergraduate level

2026 June - July, Visiting Lecturer *"Using Large Language Models for Political Science"* Bard College, OSUN, New York (via Zoom), 40h. Teaching assessment available on request

2025 June - July, Visiting Lecturer *"Using Large Language Models for Political Science"* Bard College, OSUN, New York (via Zoom), 40h

2024 June, Guest Lecture *"Use Cases for Artificial Intelligence in Social Sciences"* "Art, Decolonization, and Human Rights in the Era of AI," Bard College, OSUN, New York (via Zoom)

2019 June, Visiting Lecturer *"Regime change: democratization and democratic backslide"* course, Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf, Düsseldorf, 36h

Postgraduate level

2024 Crash Course *"Applying Artificial Intelligence in Social Sciences"* for senior scholars, Social Scientists Association, Colombo, 12h

2020 *"Regime change: democratization and democratic backslide"* course, Technical University of Darmstadt, 32h (via Zoom)

2019 *"Democratization" crash course* European University at Saint Petersburg, Saint Petersburg, 12h

Certificates

2019 Teaching in Higher Education Certificate, EUI

Public Lectures

04/2025 *"AI for Civil Society Activism"* Social Scientists' Association, Colombo, Sri Lanka
10/2022 *"What causes autocratic backsliding?"* Central European University, Budapest, Hungary
02/2019 *"The pacted transitions from authoritarian rule"* Heinrich-Heine-University Düsseldorf, Germany
2019 Departmental Seminar, Department of Political Science, European University at Saint Petersburg

Working experience

2024-2025 *Postdoctoral Fellow,* South Asia hub of the Global Forum on Democracy and Development, OSUN/ Central European University
2023-2024 *Postdoctoral Fellow,* Democracy Institute, Central European University, Budapest, Hungary
2022-2023 *Postdoctoral Fellow,* Institute for Advanced Studies, Central European University, Budapest, Hungary
2021 *Visiting researcher,* Aleksanteri Institute, University of Helsinki
2021 *Research assistant,* SOLID project, (supervisors Hanspeter Kriesi and Ioana-Elena Oana), EUI, Florence
2019-2020 *Research assistant,* "MEP trajectories" project, EUI, Florence
2019 *Assistant,* Migration Policy Center, EUI, Florence
2018 *Research assistant,* "Dictatorship textbooks" project, (supervisor Prof. Elias Dinas), EUI, Florence
2015 *Researcher,* "Party nationalization" project, (supervisor Prof. Grigory Golosov), EUSP, Saint Petersburg
2015 *Researcher,* "Academic power" project, (supervisor Prof. Mikhail Sokolov), EUSP, Saint Petersburg
2013-2014 *Research Assistant,* HSE LCSR, Saint Petersburg. Research practice with statistical analysis, data collection, newsmaking, website development, translation
2012 *Research Assistant,* "Tolerance" governmental project, Bely Dom research agency, Saint Petersburg. Data collecting, database preparation, analytical commentary
2013 *Legal Assistant,* Negotiations in court, paperwork
2013 *Trainee,* Assembly of Saint Petersburg, PR department. Assistance with report writing, paperwork

Community service

2012-2016 *Member of local Electoral Commission, Yabloko party*, Saint Petersburg, Russia
2011-2012 *Member of local Electoral Commission, CPRF party*, Saint Petersburg, Russia
2011 *Electoral Observer*, Saint Petersburg, Russia

Computer skills

Proficient: RStudio
Advanced: Python, LaTeX, Stata, SPSS
Intermediate: Adobe Photoshop, Mplus, Inkscape

Languages

Russian (Native)
English (C2)
Italian (C1)